

ELVES OF THE EXTREMES



WE PRESENT THREE NEW ELVEN CIVILIZATIONS. ICE Elves, Dark Elves, and Sea Elves.

Elves of the Extremes is a monster supplement for 5e that presents elves not as wandering forest mystics, but as arcane societies shaped by elemental and environmental absolutes. Instead of relying on a single elf stat block, this book provides three distinct and escalating NPC ladders: frostbound aurora enclaves, spider-bound subterranean courts, and playful yet powerful oceanic dominions.

These are not alternate ancestries. They are alternate evolutions.

The intent of this product is magical adaptation and cultural divergence. Ice elves represent patience, foresight, and inevitability shaped by endless winter. Dark elves represent ritual hierarchy, venomous politics, and devotion to ancient spider powers. Sea elves represent fluidity, beauty, and joyful mastery of three-dimensional aquatic realms. Each ladder escalates not simply in strength, but in magical influence, environmental control, and cultural authority.

Geography, alliances, and rivalries are intentionally undefined. These NPCs can represent aurora-lit citadels suspended in glacial silence, vast web-bound cavern kingdoms ruled by silk and venom, or radiant coral metropolises thriving in living currents. They are not meant to replace traditional elves—they are branches of the same ancestral lineage, shaped by different extremes of climate, pressure, and philosophy.

Whether these cultures collaborate, clash in elemental conflict, manipulate surface realms through subtle influence, or view woodland elves as unfocused traditionalists is left entirely in the GM's hands.

ICE ELVES

“WINTER DOES NOT HURRY. WINTER ENDURES.”

Ice elves do not merely survive the cold—they harmonize with it. Their sanctuaries glow beneath auroras, their towers rise from frozen cliffs, and their patrols move like drifting snow across tundra silence. Magic is woven into daily life, from subtle frost cantrips to storm-shaping rites that preserve entire enclaves.

They are deliberate, disciplined, and patient. They believe that time itself favors those who endure. Every rung of their ladder reflects increasing mastery over cold, foresight, and battlefield control.

Ice elves are designed for:

- High-altitude or polar arcane enclaves
- Battlefield control through terrain manipulation
- Storm- and frost-driven magical encounters
- Political drama rooted in prophecy and long memory

They do not chase warmth. They shape winter.

DARK ELVES

“EVERY WEB HAS A CENTER.”

Dark elves dwell in vast cavern realms illuminated by phosphorescent fungi and ritual flame. Their society is structured like a web—interconnected, hierarchical, and unforgiving. Spider symbolism is not aesthetic; it is sacred. Venom, patience, and entrapment define both their politics and their warfare.

They are elegant, calculating, and ritual-bound. Power is layered through priesthood, arcane study, and noble houses. Each step in their ladder reflects greater influence over web magic, poison rites, and summoned arachnid forces.

Dark elves are designed for:

- Subterranean court intrigue
- Web-based battlefield lockdown encounters
- Venom and summoning-focused combat
- Ideological or religious conflicts centered on hierarchy and devotion

They do not strike wildly. They entangle.

SEA ELVES

“THE TIDE ALWAYS RETURNS.”

Sea elves thrive in coral cities, kelp forests, and open-water palaces sculpted from living reef. Their culture is vibrant, expressive, and deeply magical. They move through three dimensions with ease, shaping currents as others shape stone. Light refracts around them; music carries through water; magic flows like tide.

They are playful but not naive. Joy and artistry coexist with formidable hydromancy and command of sea life. Each rung of their ladder reflects greater influence over water, pressure, illusion, and aquatic allies.

Sea elves are designed for:

- Fully underwater adventures
- Three-dimensional battlefield encounters
- Current manipulation and displacement mechanics
- Political drama within radiant reef cities

They do not resist the sea. They dance with it.

Elves of the Extremes offers three philosophies shaped by environment: inevitability, entanglement, and fluidity. How these cultures interact—whether as rivals, distant kin, or arcane counterpoints to one another—remains entirely in the GM's hands.

ICE ELVES

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Ice Elf Child	0	Noncombatant youth raised in glacier-carved settlements, accustomed to extreme cold and disciplined communal survival.
Ice Elf Commoner	0	Hunter, fisher, or tundra artisan who supports the hold through resilience and practical skill rather than martial training.
Ice Elf Snowstrider	1/8	Light-footed archer and scout who thrives in blizzards and snowy terrain, striking from concealment.
Ice Elf Frost Sentinel	1/4	Defensive warrior trained to hold icy chokepoints and slow advancing enemies with glacial terrain control.
Ice Elf Blizzard Skirmisher	1/2	Mobile predator who weaponizes snow and ice, knocking enemies prone before finishing them with frost-forged weapons.
Ice Elf Glacier Seer	3	Arcane frost-caster who expands the battlefield into a treacherous glacial hazard while directing disciplined defense.
Ice Elf Winter Magister	5	Senior cold mage who reshapes terrain with powerful ice magic and anchors the line with layered frost control.
Ice Elf Aurora Regent	7	High-ranking ruler-mage whose presence blankets the battlefield in supernatural winter and disciplined authority.
Ice Elf Sovereign of Endless Winter	9	Supreme frost sovereign who transforms the battlefield into a domain of absolute cold and crushing glacial dominance.

DARK ELVES

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Dark Elf Child	0	Noncombatant youth raised in lightless caverns, taught silence, obedience, and survival on walls and ceilings.
Dark Elf Commoner	0	Militia laborer or artisan of the undercities who fights defensively from elevation with crossbow and dagger.
Dark Elf Web Adept	1/8	Junior web-mage who restrains targets with conjured strands and supports ambushes with darkness and faerie fire.
Dark Elf Venomblade	1/4	Assassin-soldier who strikes from vertical angles, delivering poison-laced melee blows under cover of darkness.
Dark Elf Webcaller	1/2	Battlefield controller who blankets an area in webbing, slows movement, and summons spiders to overwhelm isolated foes.
Dark Elf Arachnomancer	1	Priest-mage who combines web restraint, command magic, and summoned brood pressure to break organized resistance.
Dark Elf Silk Matron	5	Noble commander-priestess whose wide web dominion and spider sovereignty turn terrain into a trap and enemies into prey.
Dark Elf High Weaver	7	Legendary ruler of ambush doctrine who locks down territory with superior webs, commands elite brood, and shifts through shadow.
Dark Elf Spider Sovereign	9	Supreme undercity sovereign who transforms the battlefield into imperial web territory and crushes foes with brood and poison control.

SEA ELVES

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Sea Elf Child	0	Underwater youth armed with simple shell tools, raised among reefs and currents with tide-hardened will.
Sea Elf Commoner	0	Fisher, diver, or reef artisan who can defend the shoal with spear and sling when danger reaches the coral.
Sea Elf Reef Scout	1/8	Stealthy reef skirmisher who blends into coral terrain, slips away after strikes, and restrains prey with nets.
Sea Elf Tidemarshal	1/4	Formation guard who drives foes with underwater force, anchors allies, and controls approach lanes with disciplined pressure.
Sea Elf Waveblade	1	Agile duelist who pulls enemies into kill ranges with current manipulation and disables movement with harpoon strikes.
Sea Elf Tidecaller	3	Current-shaping spellcaster who turns the battlefield into hostile flow, knocks enemies prone, and repositions allies through the water.
Sea Elf Coral Commander	5	Tactical leader who amplifies shoal teamwork, strengthens current control, and directs coordinated strikes and redeployments.
Sea Elf Abyssal Herald	7	Legendary deep commander whose dominion hurls enemies through churning water while commanding allied movement with relentless precision.
Sea Elf Tidelord Sovereign	9	Supreme ruler of the deep who transforms an underwater battlefield into a controlled maelstrom of forced movement, cohesion, and collapse.

ICE ELF BLIZZARD SKIRMISHER

Medium humanoid (elf), neutral

Armor Class 15 (studded leather armor)

Hit Points 52 (8d8 + 16)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	17 (+3)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)

Skills Perception +4, Stealth +5

Damage Resistances cold

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages Common, Elvish

Challenge 1/2 (100 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Fey Ancestry. This elf has advantage on saving throws against being charmed, and magic can't put this elf to sleep.

Snowstrider. This elf ignores difficult terrain caused by snow or ice.

Glacial Field. The ground in a 15-foot radius around this elf is icy difficult terrain for hostile creatures. A hostile creature that enters the area for the first time on a turn or starts its turn there must succeed on a DC 12 Dexterity saving throw or fall prone.

ACTIONS:

Multiattack (2). This elf makes two weapon attacks.

Frost Blade. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 3) slashing damage plus 3 (1d6) cold damage.

Frost Arrow. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, range 150/600 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d8 + 3) piercing damage plus 3 (1d6) cold damage.

- Use Glacial Field aggressively to knock enemies prone before unleashing Multiattack.
- Position the Skirmisher slightly ahead of other Ice Elves to create layered difficult terrain.
- Focus ranged pressure on prone targets for tactical advantage.
- These elves should feel mobile and predatory, striking and repositioning rather than holding static lines.



DARK ELF SPIDER SOVEREIGN

Medium humanoid (elf), neutral evil

Armor Class 19 (enchanted studded leather armor)

Hit Points 195 (26d8 + 78)

Speed 30 ft., climb 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	20 (+5)	16 (+3)	21 (+5)	19 (+4)	22 (+6)

Saving Throws Dex +9, Int +9, Wis +8, Cha +10

Skills Arcana +9, Deception +10, Insight +8, Perception +8, Religion +9

Damage Resistances poison

Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 18

Languages Common, Elvish, Undercommon

Challenge 9 (5,000 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +4

Umbral Lineage. This elf has advantage on saving throws against being charmed. In addition, this elf has advantage on saving throws against poison, and it has resistance to poison damage.

Sunlight Aversion. While in bright sunlight, this elf has disadvantage on attack rolls and on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on sight.

Spider Climber. This elf can climb difficult surfaces, including upside down on ceilings, without needing to make an ability check.

Legendary Resistance (3/Day). If this elf fails a saving throw, it can choose to succeed instead.

Spellcasting. This elf is a 15th-level spellcaster. Its spellcasting ability is Intelligence (spell save DC 17, +9 to hit with spell attacks). This elf requires no material components.

- **Cantrips (at will):** [poison spray](#)
- **1st level (1 slot):** [faerie fire](#)
- **2nd level (3 slots):** [hold person](#), [web](#), [darkness](#)
- **3rd level (3 slots):** [counterspell](#), [fear](#)
- **4th level (3 slots):** [greater invisibility](#)
- **5th level (3 slots):** [dominate person](#), [wall of force](#), [cloudkill](#)
- **6th level (1 slot):** [circle of death](#)

Web Dominion. A 60-foot-radius area centered on this elf is filled with thick conjured webbing. The area is lightly obscured for hostile creatures and is difficult terrain for them. A hostile creature that starts its turn in the area must succeed on a DC 17 Dexterity saving throw or become restrained by webbing

until the end of its turn. If a creature fails this saving throw by 5 or more, it is restrained until the start of its next turn instead. The webbing persists for 1 minute, even if this elf moves, and fades only if this elf is reduced to 0 hit points.

Spider Sovereignty. Allied spiders and spider swarms within 90 feet of this elf have advantage on attack rolls against creatures restrained by webbing and gain a +4 bonus to damage rolls. In addition, restrained creatures within 60 feet of this elf have disadvantage on saving throws against poison.

ACTIONS:

Multiattack (2). This elf makes two attacks: one with its venom blade and one with its web lance.

Venom Blade. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 11 (1d6 + 8) piercing damage plus 28 (8d6) poison damage.

Web Lance. *Ranged Spell Attack:* +9 to hit, range 150 ft., one target. *Hit:* 31 (7d8) poison damage, and the target's speed is reduced by 20 feet until the end of its next turn.

BONUS ACTIONS:

Summon Royal Brood (1/Day). This elf magically summons one phase spider and three giant spiders. The summoned creatures appear in unoccupied spaces within 60 feet of this elf and act immediately after this elf in the initiative order. The creatures remain for 1 minute, until reduced to 0 hit points, or until dismissed as a bonus action.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS:

The Dark Elf Spider Sovereign can take 3 legendary actions, choosing from the options below. Only one legendary action option can be used at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn. The Spider Sovereign regains spent legendary actions at the start of its turn.

Web Snap (1 Action). One creature restrained by webbing within 60 feet must succeed on a DC 17 Constitution saving throw or take 14 (4d6) poison damage, or half as much damage on a successful save.

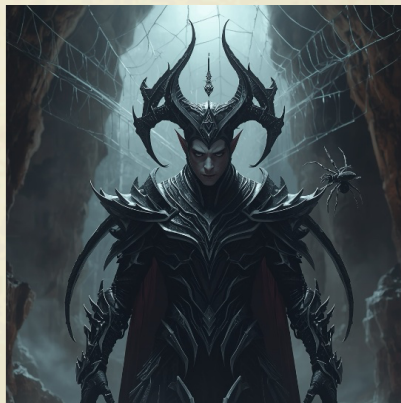
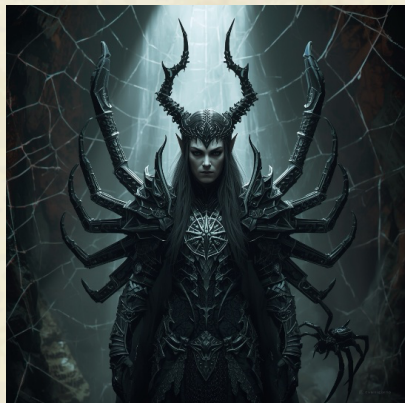
Brood Command (1 Action). One allied spider within 90 feet can immediately use its reaction to make one attack.

Shadow Step (1 Action). The Spider Sovereign magically teleports up to 40 feet to an unoccupied space it can see that is in dim light or darkness.

Tighten the Web (2 Actions). Each hostile creature restrained by webbing within 60 feet takes 10 (3d6) poison damage.

- Establish Imperial Web Dominion immediately; the Sovereign wins by territory control.
- Use [wall of force](#) or [cloudkill](#) to isolate clusters before tightening the web.
- Keep elevation and darkness in play—Spider Climber and Shadow Step ensure constant positional advantage.
- Tighten the Web should follow Brood Command volleys for maximum pressure on restrained targets.

DARK ELF SPIDER SOVEREIGN



SEA ELF ABYSSAL HERALD

Medium humanoid (elf), neutral

Armor Class 19 (enchanted coral armor)

Hit Points 168 (24d8 + 72)

Speed 30 ft., swim 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	18 (+4)	18 (+4)	17 (+3)	19 (+4)	20 (+5)

Saving Throws Dex +7, Con +7, Wis +7, Cha +8

Skills Athletics +5, Perception +7, Insight +7, Nature +6

Damage Resistances cold

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 18

Languages Common, Elvish, Aquan

Challenge 7 (2,900 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +3

Tideborn Mind. The mind of this elf is shaped by the deep currents and ancient tides. This elf is immune to the charmed condition and cannot be put to sleep by magic.

Sea Adaptation. This elf can breathe both air and water.

Legendary Resistance (2/Day). If this elf fails a saving throw, it can choose to succeed instead.

Spellcasting. This elf is a 13th-level spellcaster. Its spellcasting ability is Wisdom (spell save DC 15, +7 to hit with spell attacks). This elf requires no material components for spells that manipulate water or storms.

- **Cantrips (at will):** [mage hand](#)
- **1st level (4 slots):** [fog cloud](#), [thunderwave](#)
- **3rd level (3 slots):** [call lightning](#)
- **4th level (3 slots):** [control water](#)

Current Dominion. While underwater, a 50-foot-radius area centered on this elf is filled with powerful, churning currents. The area counts as difficult terrain for hostile creatures. A hostile creature that starts its turn in the area must succeed on a DC 16 Strength saving throw or be pushed up to 20 feet in a

direction of the Abyssal Herald's choice. If a creature fails this saving throw by 5 or more, it is also knocked prone.

Shoal Mastery. Allied creatures within 60 feet of this elf gain a +2 bonus to damage rolls while underwater if they are within 5 feet of at least one ally.

ACTIONS:

Multiattack (2). This elf makes two attacks: one with its coral glaive and one with its current surge.

Coral Glaive. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 9 (1d10 + 4) slashing damage.

Current Surge. *Ranged Spell Attack:* +8 to hit, range 150 ft., one target. *Hit:* 28 (8d6) bludgeoning damage. If the target is underwater, it must succeed on a DC 16 Strength saving throw or be pushed 20 feet and knocked prone.

BONUS ACTIONS:

Reposition the Tide (Recharge 4–6). While underwater, this elf magically moves up to three willing allied creatures it can see within 60 feet up to 40 feet each to unoccupied spaces it can see.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS:

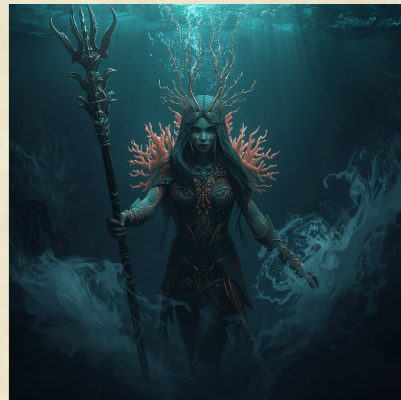
The Sea Elf Abyssal Herald can take 2 legendary actions, choosing from the options below. Only one legendary action option can be used at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn. The Abyssal Herald regains spent legendary actions at the start of its turn.

Current Shift (1 Action). One hostile creature within 60 feet that is underwater must succeed on a DC 16 Strength saving throw or be pushed 10 feet in a direction of the Herald's choice.

Shoal Command (1 Action). One allied creature within 60 feet can immediately move up to half its speed without provoking opportunity attacks.

Surging Step (1 Action). The Herald moves up to its swim speed without provoking opportunity attacks.

- Control wide underwater territory with Current Dominion.
- Use Legendary Actions to constantly reposition the battlefield.
- Push enemies into clusters for allied focus.
- The fight should feel like battling within a storming current.



COMPATIBLE CONTENT

Ice Elves can be found at the [Winter Wall](#), in a [Winter Tavern](#), or in the arctic [Wilderness Maps](#).

Dark Elves can be found in the [Dark Elf Tavern](#), or the humanoid section of a [Dungeon Crawl](#).

Sea Elves in the [Triton Tavern](#).

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